



STATUS REPORT

Malawi: status report

Edition of 2026-08-16 · 152 systems and instruments tracked, 58 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-14 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/MWI/ledger.csv](#) (152 systems and instruments, 58 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Malawi holds one digital system close to complete and a set of governing instruments that are not. The national identity register carried more than 13.5 million adult identities by July 2026, about 99% of those aged 16 and over ([registration bureau](#)). The Data Protection Act 2024 has been in force since 3 June 2024, but the statute exempted controllers and processors not of significant importance for twenty-four months, and that exemption elapsed in early June 2026 with the registration regime still in draft consultation ([draft regulations](#)).

The distance between built systems and the rules governing them is the defining feature of the record. Public procurement became electronic-only from 1 April 2026 ([procurement authority](#)), while in June 2026 the ICT minister stated that government institutions were still sharing citizen data by email, USB drive and paper ([ministry account](#)).

The record is thinnest where it would need to be strongest to test any of this: nothing is held on energy supply to networks, on technical capacity or on digital literacy, and the regulator publishes no sector statistics the wiki holds.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Access Communications licence	IMPLEMENTED, MARGINAL SHARE ↗	Licensed 2007

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Additional mobile operator licensing round	PLANNED ↗	Minister told Parliament the President had authorised the ministry to identify an investor
Airtel Malawi satellite connectivity plan	PLANNED ↗	Interest signalled at the 27th annual general meeting
Communication tower programme	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Procurement of service providers for more than 90 towers advanced
Converged Technology Networks fixed-wireless network	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Five new base stations switched on in Lilongwe, 11 August 2026
Digital Malawi Acceleration Project	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Tower procurement advanced at a Blantyre stakeholder meeting
Four-year ICT investment plan	PLANNED ↗	Roadmap presented to the vendor in China
Last Mile Connectivity and National Data Centre loan	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Authorised by Parliament 2019-01-25
Malawi Digital Foundations Project	DISCONTINUED, CLOSED ON COMPLETION ↗	Closed 2024-10-31 after board approval 2017-06-05
Malcel licence	PLANNED, NO LAUNCH DATE ↗	Late-2023 launch target passed without commercial launch
National Fibre Backbone Project, Phases I and II	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Phase II concessional loan committed 2020, start year 2021
Nyasa Mobile licence	PLANNED, NO LAUNCH DATE ↗	Licensed 2022, no commercial launch date announced
Satellite connectivity for rural schools	IMPLEMENTED ↗	30 rural schools reported activated
Spectrum licence fee reduction	IMPLEMENTED, EFFECTIVE DATE UNESTABLISHED ↗	20% reduction announced by the regulator
Tariff-notice requirement under the Communications Act 2016	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Compensation order issued 2026-07-17
TNM 5G network	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched in Lilongwe 2025-07-26
International capacity and submarine cable landing arrangements	NOT HELD	—
Mobile and internet subscriber and coverage series	NOT HELD	—
National fibre backbone route length and operating status	NOT HELD	—

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Boma Lathu National Data Exchange Platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Immigration e-services integration agreed at a Lilongwe meeting
Commercial data centre, Lilongwe	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched at the company's technology event
National Data Centre, Lilongwe	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Immigration e-services integration onto locally hosted infrastructure
TNM third data centre	PLANNED ↗	Announced for construction within three months
Data localisation or residency requirement	NOT HELD	—

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Solar-powered coverage extension	PLANNED ↗	Stated at the operator's 30th-anniversary event
Delivered IT load of the national and commercial data centres	NOT HELD	—

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Electrification programme for the roughly 900 schools with no connectivity	NOT HELD	—
Grid supply and reliability as it constrains telecom sites and data centres	NOT HELD	—
Off-grid and solar powering of rural base stations under the tower programme	NOT HELD	—

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Artificial intelligence laboratories and innovation hubs	PLANNED ↗	Announced for the following year at the operator's 30th-anniversary event
Malawi Research and Education Network	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reported at the foundations project's close
Engineering and operations staffing of the regulator, the response team and the e-government department	NOT HELD	—
Government cloud or shared hosting service for ministries and agencies	NOT HELD	—
Malawi Internet Exchange Point	NOT HELD	—

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Chinese safe-city surveillance package offer	PLANNED, NOT PROCEEDING ↗	Recorded as rejected in a five-country research report
Malawi Computer Emergency Response Team	IMPLEMENTED, HOUSED INSIDE THE REGULATOR ↗	Independence stated as intended at a World Bank meeting in Blantyre
World Bank cybersecurity and data-protection technical assistance	PLANNED ↗	Commitment announced at a Blantyre meeting
Critical information infrastructure designation	NOT HELD	—
Electronic Transactions and Cyber Security Act 2016 and its enforcement record	NOT HELD	—
Incidents handled by the computer emergency response team	NOT HELD	—
National cybersecurity strategy or policy	NOT HELD	—

Connectivity policy is set by statements rather than by published instruments. The regulator cut spectrum licence fees by 20% in June 2025 ([regulator announcement](#)), but no fee schedule or gazette notice is held, so neither the base amounts nor the date the reduced fees took effect can be stated. The ICT minister told Parliament on 17 July 2026 that the reduction had been 50%; five contemporaneous accounts of the regulator's own announcement give 20% ([parliamentary account](#)).

Market structure has not moved. What the regulator did enforce in the window was notice, not price: it found both mobile operators in breach of the tariff-publication requirement and ordered compensation, while the approved increase itself stands ([regulator order](#)).

Rural coverage rests on a tower programme the appraisal document does not contain. The regulator was procuring providers for more than 90 towers in March 2026, against a requirement of more than 1,000 cited at the same meeting ([procurement briefing](#)); the project's own appraisal carries no tower line ([appraisal document](#)).

Only 3% of web content consumed in Malawi is served from within the country and 62% regionally, mainly from South Africa — the lowest local share among the economies measured ([content-locality measurement](#)).

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Customs IT connectivity arrangement with South Africa	PLANNED ↗	Signed 2026-08-05, no go-live date stated
Enterprise Service Bus	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Industry association pressing the e-government department to onboard all agencies
Malawi National Single Window	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched May 2025

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Blockchain-enabled Digital ID Wallet	PILOTING ↗	Stated to be in pilot ahead of nationwide rollout
Electoral management devices and the electronic voter register	IMPLEMENTED ↗	6,500 devices deployed at the 16 September 2025 elections
Mandatory biometric SIM registration	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Programme start 1 July 2025, registration window to September 2025
National Registration and Identification System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In operation since the National Registration Act came into force in 2015
Nzika Wallet mobile digital ID	PILOTING ↗	Launch announced for September 2026
Death registration coverage	NOT HELD	—

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Competition authority interoperability order on mobile-money e-ticketing	IMPLEMENTED, COMPLIANCE UNREPORTED ↗	Order issued 2025-07-16 with one year to comply
Mobile money integration with the agricultural marketing corporation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched in Blantyre
National e-Payment Gateway	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Reported as a 2025 breakthrough despite integration hurdles
National Payments Systems Vision and Strategy 2026-2030	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched by the Reserve Bank of Malawi
National Switch	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In operation since 2015
Regional digital retail payments platform, Malawi-Zambia corridor	IMPLEMENTED, ONE CORRIDOR ONLY ↗	First Malawi-Zambia cross-border local-currency payment
Central bank digital currency proof of concept	NOT HELD	—

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Land Information Management System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Workflow review workshop convened
National Addressing System Project	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Programme described by the regulator on its site
National Birth Registration Campaign	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Phase 1 witnessed at Dedza
Rental income tax property registration drive	IMPLEMENTED ↗	About 8,000 landlords registered
Business and company registration system	NOT HELD	—
Customary land registration under the Customary Land Act 2016	NOT HELD	—

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Automated human resource and payroll management platform	PILOTING ↗	Pilot reported ahead of government-wide rollout
Crime Management System	PILOTING ↗	Three-day technical training opened in Lilongwe
Electronic Invoicing System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Full enforcement and penalties from 2026-05-01
Health Management Information System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Fieldwork across six church-network facilities, August 2023
Public Sector Reforms Information Management System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched December 2025
Education Management Information System	NOT HELD	—

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Malawi National Electronic Procurement System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Mandatory for all public entities from 2026-04-01
New passport issuance system	IMPLEMENTED, BACKLOG UNRESOLVED ↗	Printing resumed at Mangochi, stated in Parliament
Passport queue transparency and tracking features	PLANNED ↗	Accepted in principle in Parliament, deferred until the passport system stabilises
Driver's licence online renewal	NOT HELD	—

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Agricultural Data Infrastructure	PLANNED ↗	Framework proposed; nothing built
University AI fertigation facility, Thyolo	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Commissioned 2026-07-17, greenhouse planted from August 2026

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Blantyre City Council digital revenue collection	PLANNED ↗	Partnership agreement signed
Constituency Development Fund real-time dashboard	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Coverage and complaints channel stated by the ministry 2026-08-04

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Governance to Enable Service Delivery Project 2.0	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Ratified by Parliament 2026-07-29
Local Authorities ICT Policy and ICT standards	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Validated 2026-05-04, council sensitisation under way
Local Authority Performance Assessment	IMPLEMENTED ↗	2025/26 results announced

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Payments System Report series	IMPLEMENTED ↗	2025 annual report published 2026-03-30
Financial inclusion consumer survey, next round	NOT HELD	—
National Statistical Office release programme	NOT HELD	—

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National earth-observation or satellite data programme	NOT HELD	—

The identity layer is the one part of the record stated with confidence: more than 13.5 million people held a national identity by July 2026, about 99% of those aged 16 and over ([registration bureau](#)). A mobile credential was announced for September 2026 ([registration bureau](#)); a separate blockchain wallet is in pilot under a United Nations programme, and neither names the other, so whether they are one product or two is unestablished.

About 4.6 million children remain without a birth certificate, against a campaign requiring MWK 17.8bn of which MWK 5.4bn was allocated for its first two phases ([ministerial figures](#)).

The national data centre and exchange platform were delivered under the foundations project ([project results](#)), and 25 e-services were being onboarded by July 2026, the immigration department integrating while retaining ownership of its data ([e-government department](#)). The data-sharing regulation the ICT minister proposed in June 2026 to govern that exchange is not made ([ministry account](#)), and the service bus intended to carry it was not operationalised through 2025, leaving passport registration and driver's licence payments unavailable online.

The ministry states that the constituency development fund dashboard, launched on 31 July 2026, carries progress, budgets and locations for more than 2,000 projects; no address for it is established ([ministry account](#)). The launching minister named the President, the finance and information ministers and the Office of the President and Cabinet as having real-time access, and said the dashboard depends on councils uploading data manually, warning of no excuse for late uploads ([minister's remarks](#)).

Mobile money carried MWK 37.9tn in 2025, but merchant payments were 7.7% of transactions against airtime at 42%, which the central bank reads as continued cash substitution ([central bank report](#)).

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
AI Bill	PLANNED ↗	Announced by the ICT minister at the Heads of ICT meeting, Lilongwe
Data Protection Act 2024	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Commenced 2024-06-03; the 24-month general exemption elapsed early June 2026
Financial Crimes (Amendment) Bill No. 19 of 2026	IN DEVELOPMENT, PASSED BY PARLIAMENT AWAITING ASSENT ↗	Passed by Parliament in the week to 2026-08-06
Government Data Sharing Regulation	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Proposed regulation announced by the Ministry of ICT
Review of the National Registration Act	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Stakeholder consultative meeting concluded in Lilongwe
Access to Information Act 2017	NOT HELD	—
Government Notice 40 of 2024, commencement of the Data Protection Act	NOT HELD	—
National Statistics Act 2013	NOT HELD	—

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Draft National Artificial Intelligence Strategy	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Validation workshop opened 2026-02-18; readiness assessment validated 2026-07-22
Draft National Digital Transformation Strategy	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Validation workshop opened at the international conference centre
Malawi Digitalisation Policy 2023-28	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Named as the framework local-authority and sectoral ICT policy must align to
Presidential directive on digitalisation of public services	PLANNED ↗	Directive given in the State of the Nation Address

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Lilongwe Declaration on Collaborative Regulation	IMPLEMENTED, VOLUNTARY AND NON-BINDING ↗	Adopted at the close of the regional regulators' summit, Lilongwe, 13-15 April 2026
Regulator collaboration with UNDP on AI, digital identity and data protection	PLANNED ↗	Priority areas identified in discussions; no agreement recorded
SADC Regional AI Strategy and Regulatory Framework	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Reported under development at a regional ministerial meeting
Ratification or transposition of AU or SADC data instruments	NOT HELD	—

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Blank media levy distribution methodology	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Digital-consumption proposal rejected at an annual general meeting
Copyright society rule on wholly AI-generated works	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Decision date not established; reported 2026-07-23 as taken some weeks earlier

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Lilongwe Declaration on Collaborative Regulation, text	NOT HELD	—

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Data Protection Authority within the regulator	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Head of data protection named and an implementation framework reported
Draft Data Protection Regulations, Guidelines and Registration Fees	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Stakeholder consultation held in Blantyre
Separation of the data protection authority and the emergency response team from the regulator	PLANNED ↗	Announced at a World Bank meeting in Blantyre
Enforcement under the Data Protection Act 2024	NOT HELD	—
Regulator misinformation and disinformation tracking system	NOT HELD	—
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	NOT HELD	—

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Public and parliamentary contestation of Malawi's data governance	NOT HELD	—

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
EU-Malawi digital and data governance cooperation	NOT HELD	—

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Machine-readable access to the electronic voter register	IMPLEMENTED, ACCESS REFUSED ↗	Chief Elections Officer refused the request
Malawi Low Resource Language Data Trust	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Launched at the national language data trust workshop, Lilongwe

The Data Protection Act 2024 commenced on 3 June 2024 and designated the communications regulator as data protection authority ([the Act](#)). Sixteen months later the government was still tendering consultancy for the authority's organogram, staffing and enforcement framework ([terms of reference](#)).

The twenty-four-month exemption elapsed in early June 2026. By then the regulator had published draft regulations and a turnover-based fee schedule from MWK 50,000 for small and medium enterprises to MWK 7 million for the largest controllers and processors, consulted on 13 July 2026 ([consultation account](#)). No commencement date for the regulations is on record, and the day the exemption fell cannot be settled: the circulating expiry of 2 June 2026 implies a 2 June 2024 commencement, and the notice is not held.

No fine, order, breach notification, complaint or prosecution under the Act appears in the base, two years after commencement. Malawi's bilateral health agreements with the United States, and the data-sharing agreements attached to them, are [withheld and in litigation](#) since 2 April 2026.

A national digital transformation strategy and a national AI strategy, the latter backed by an [AI Bill announced on 6 August 2026](#), both entered validation in February 2026; a local-authority ICT policy was validated in May 2026 with no adoption date; and the proposed data-sharing regulation is not made ([ministry account](#)). Parliament passed the Financial Crimes (Amendment) Bill No. 19 of 2026 in the week to 6 August 2026, removing references to cheques and bearer negotiable instruments; assent and commencement are not on record ([parliamentary account](#)).

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Defence force cooperation with China on military AI and cybersecurity	PLANNED ↗	Intention stated by the Defence Minister at a People's Liberation Army anniversary event, Lilongwe
UNESCO AI Readiness Assessment report	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Validated at a Lilongwe workshop
Adopted National AI Strategy, text and adoption instrument	NOT HELD	—
Artificial intelligence governance institution	NOT HELD	—
Copyright society directive on AI-generated works	NOT HELD	—
Military artificial intelligence doctrine, oversight or procurement record	NOT HELD	—

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Bank of Malawi and ICT Association Innovation Jam	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Three-year memorandum signed alongside a MWK 75,500,000 donation
Count of licensed technology firms and data centre operators	NOT HELD	—
ICT sector share of GDP and sector employment	NOT HELD	—
Official ICT services export series after 2023	NOT HELD	—

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
PayChangu	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Founded 2021; unified payment infrastructure profiled
University innovation lab	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Since 2019; scheduled end year 2026
Unlocking Talent e-learning programme	DISCONTINUED, TERM COMPLETED ↗	Closed at end-2024; US\$14,522,971 of US\$14,549,922 disbursed
National innovation or venture fund	NOT HELD	—
Startup Act or innovation legislation	NOT HELD	—
Startup funding raised, deals or jobs created	NOT HELD	—
Technology hubs and incubators operating in Malawi	NOT HELD	—

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
United States-Malawi technology cooperation	NOT HELD	—

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Current position on the Chinese safe-city surveillance package	NOT HELD	—

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
India-Malawi technology cooperation	NOT HELD	—

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Gulf state technology investment in Malawi	NOT HELD	—

Malawi holds no state-published artificial intelligence document. Every position the wiki carries is known through reporting of workshops and ministerial statements rather than through a text. A readiness assessment run by the education ministry with UNESCO was validated on 22 July 2026 and put 27.7% of the population online against household computer ownership of 4.2% ([validation account](#)). The strategy it is meant to guide remains pre-adoption, and the assessment sits with a different ministry from the one that owns it.

The sector's own measures are equally thin. ICT services exports rose from about US\$70m in 2020 to US\$154m in 2023, on a private-sector managing director's account at an industry expo rather than an official statistic. No statistical release gives the sector's share of gross domestic product or its employment.

The largest technology proposal on record is unsigned: a four-year roadmap presented to Huawei in China in June 2026 seeking US\$180m, covering a one-stop government platform and a network linking all 28 districts, with funding structure and timeline not made public ([ministry account](#)). Against that, one dated position of a different kind stands: of five countries studied in 2023, Malawi was the only one recorded as having rejected the safe-city surveillance package offered by Chinese companies, though the base holds no account of who rejected it or on what grounds.

A statutory copyright body has meanwhile set an authorship rule ahead of the state, declining to register works created entirely by artificial intelligence, with no published test for how much assistance is admissible and no decision date established.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Universal Service Fund	IMPLEMENTED, UNDER-RESOURCED ↗	Director General stated funding levels insufficient
Rural-urban and gender divide in internet use	NOT HELD	—

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Retail data and device affordability	NOT HELD	—

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National digital literacy measure or programme	NOT HELD	—

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Airtel Nzeru Connect school programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Expansion announced 2026-07-15
Airtel Nzeru Fund STEM scholarships	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-01-07 with 25 places
Data Protection Authority operationalisation consultancy	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Terms of reference issued October 2025
Acceleration project training and skills results	NOT HELD	—

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National research capacity in digital technologies	NOT HELD	—

The measures that would show whether Malawi's digital systems reach people are largely absent, and where they exist they are unflattering. The most recent national internet-penetration figure the wiki holds is around 24 users per 100 inhabitants, from a May 2024 appraisal on a 2022 baseline ([appraisal document](#)). No measured value for any date inside the past year is held, against a presidential target of 80% internet usage by 2026 stated without a baseline.

Schools are the clearest case. 85% of Malawi's 9,000 schools have limited or no internet access and about 900 have none at all, with lack of electricity and of devices named as the main barriers ([landscape analysis](#)).

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Governance to Enable Service Delivery Project	DISCONTINUED ↗	Closed 2026-06-30
Inclusive Digital Transformation for Malawi	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Draft AI and digital transformation strategies entered validation
Malawi Fiscal Governance Program-for-Results	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Program appraisal document 2024-04-26, SDR 60.3m
Support for Digitalization, Financial Inclusion and Competitiveness	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Grant of XDR 10,000,000, commitment year 2021
Domestic state financing of digital transformation	NOT HELD	—

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Vendor investment memorandum	PLANNED ↗	Roadmap presented in China; no agreement made public
The Malawi-vendor signed instrument	NOT HELD	—

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Malawi national budget documents	NOT HELD	—
Universal Service Fund accounts	NOT HELD	—

The 2026/27 national budget carries no dedicated line for school connectivity; the nearest digital allocation is MWK 1.1bn for assembling laptops and tablets at a university ([landscape analysis](#)).

The universal service fund itself is under-resourced: its Director General said in March 2026 that existing funding levels remain insufficient, and no income, balance or disbursement figure is held for any year ([procurement briefing](#)).

What is financed is financed externally. Parliament ratified an SDR 58.2m grant for local-government service delivery on 29 July 2026, of which US\$12.8m funds business-process re-engineering, system assessments and a performance dashboard ([parliamentary approval](#)). There is no domestic budget archive for Malawi, so every appropriation figure the wiki carries is a journalist's or a minister's reading.

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Grid supply and reliability as it constrains telecom sites and data centres	A utility annual report or energy regulator sector statistics giving generation capacity, delivered energy, outage duration and the industrial tariff; nothing in the wiki is tagged to this subject for Malawi at any date	not yet probed
Delivered IT load of the national and commercial data centres	An acceleration-project procurement or supervision document, or an operator data-sheet, stating design and delivered critical load and backup generation	not yet probed
Electrification programme for the roughly 900 schools with no connectivity	A Ministry of Education or Ministry of Energy programme document, or the 2026/27 budget detail, naming a school-electrification line with a school count and appropriation	not yet probed
Off-grid and solar powering of rural base stations under the tower programme	The regulator's tower procurement tender documents, which would state the power specification for the more than 90 sites	not yet probed
Malawi Internet Exchange Point	A regulator or Internet Society record of the exchange's members, peak traffic and peering ratio; the base holds a 3% local-content figure but nothing on the interconnection layer that would explain it	not yet probed
Government cloud or shared hosting service for ministries and agencies	An e-government department service catalogue or project component report stating what the national data centre actually offers agencies and on what terms	not yet probed
Engineering and operations staffing of the regulator, the response team and the e-government department	An establishment table or annual report giving approved and filled technical posts	not yet probed
National cybersecurity strategy or policy	A published Malawi national cybersecurity strategy, or a Ministry of ICT statement confirming none exists; the base holds cybersecurity only as a component of other instruments	not yet probed
Electronic Transactions and Cyber Security Act 2016 and its enforcement record	The Act as gazetted plus any prosecution or enforcement statistics; the base cites the Communications Act 2016 repeatedly but holds nothing on Malawi's cybercrime statute	not yet probed
Incidents handled by the computer emergency response team	A response team or regulator annual report giving incidents reported and resolved by year	not yet probed
Critical information infrastructure designation	A statutory instrument or regulator notice designating critical information infrastructure and the obligations attaching to it; named as a World Bank assistance area in March 2026 with no instrument on file	not yet probed
National fibre backbone route length and operating status	A regulator sector report or ICT ministry statement giving fibre kilometres in service and the operator, against roughly US\$140m of Chinese lending committed across two phases	not yet probed
Mobile and internet subscriber and coverage series	A regulator quarterly or annual sector statistics report giving subscribers, penetration and population coverage by technology; the base has no regulator-published series for Malawi at all	not yet probed
International capacity and submarine cable landing arrangements	A record of Malawi's transit arrangements through Mozambique, Tanzania or Zambia and the cable systems they reach; Malawi is landlocked and the base says nothing about how its traffic leaves the country	not yet probed
Data localisation or residency requirement	The Data Protection Act's cross-border transfer provisions or an implementing regulation; sovereignty is the stated rationale for local hosting throughout, with no legal requirement identified	not yet probed
Death registration coverage	A registration bureau figure for deaths registered after 2025; the last held figure is under 200,000 stated at 2025-05-28 against over 3.5m births registered	not yet probed
Business and company registration system	A Registrar General statement or e-government service listing establishing whether business registration is live on the national platform; it is named only as a target in the vendor portal proposal	not yet probed
Customary land registration under the Customary Land Act 2016	A lands ministry figure for customary estates registered and district land registries operating; the only source held is a 2020 donor programme reflection reporting three district registries	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Driver's licence online renewal	A road traffic directorate or national platform service listing; it is named as a presidential directive target and an industry association ask, with no delivery record	not yet probed
Education Management Information System	A Ministry of Education statistical bulletin or system description; the only education source held is a 2024 rapid scan, which is landscape framing and carries no system position	not yet probed
Central bank digital currency proof of concept	The National Payments Systems Vision and Strategy document itself; the held press account of the launch names no such work, and the wiki holds no central bank publication	not yet probed
National earth-observation or satellite data programme	Any dated statement from the surveys department, the meteorological department or the regulator naming a satellite data holding, ground station or earth-observation data-sharing arrangement; the base holds zero Malawi sources on this subject	not yet probed
National Statistical Office release programme	The office's published release calendar, or the census and integrated household survey report pages; no statistical office output at all is held for Malawi	not yet probed
Financial inclusion consumer survey, next round	A survey round later than the 2023 edition published August 2024; the base holds no successor and no announced fieldwork date	not yet probed
Government Notice 40 of 2024, commencement of the Data Protection Act	The gazette text, which would settle whether commencement was 2 or 3 June 2024 and therefore when the general exemption elapsed	not yet probed
Access to Information Act 2017	The Act's text, the information commission's annual report, or any request-and-response record; the base names the Act once, in a 2022 essay, and holds nothing on whether it operates	not yet probed
National Statistics Act 2013	The Act's text or a statistical office statement; named once in a 2022 essay, with no position held on the statistical system's legal basis or its interaction with the Data Protection Act	not yet probed
Enforcement under the Data Protection Act 2024	A regulator enforcement register, annual report or published determination; no fine, order, breach notification, complaint or prosecution under the Act appears in anything held, more than two years after commencement	not yet probed
Regulator misinformation and disinformation tracking system	A regulator notice or procurement record establishing when the system was introduced, its legal basis and its data-handling terms; the base has only a newspaper year-review reporting its introduction in 2025	not yet probed
Lilongwe Declaration on Collaborative Regulation, text	The regional regulators' association publication of the Declaration, unpublished at 2026-08-05, so a named-analyst commentary is the whole of the wiki's account and the seven action areas are nowhere enumerated	not yet probed
Ratification or transposition of AU or SADC data instruments	An instrument of ratification for the AU Malabo Convention, or a Malawian instrument transposing the AU Data Policy Framework or a regional model law; the base records only that the Data Protection Act aligns closely with the continental framework, in a third-party legal review	not yet probed
Public and parliamentary contestation of Malawi's data governance	Hansard for the sittings at which the Data Protection Act and the financing bills were debated; the base holds only two sources on this subject for Malawi, one of them a paywalled lede	not yet probed
EU-Malawi digital and data governance cooperation	Any EU-Malawi instrument text or Delegation statement addressing data governance; no Malawi source in the base carries this tag at all, and the EU material held is tagged to identity and registry subjects and says nothing about data-governance alignment or adequacy	not yet probed
United States-Malawi technology cooperation	A signed cooperation agreement, an embassy or State Department announcement, or a development finance or aid agency digital programme record naming Malawi; the base holds no United States-specific technology item for Malawi	not yet probed
Current position on the Chinese safe-city surveillance package	A government or regulator statement, or a procurement record, showing whether the 2023 rejection still stands	not yet probed
India-Malawi technology cooperation	A bilateral memorandum, Indian line-of-credit record or e-network programme document naming Malawi; nothing is held	not yet probed
Gulf state technology investment in Malawi	An investment agreement, sovereign-fund announcement or ministry statement naming a UAE, Saudi or Qatari counterparty; nothing is held	not yet probed
Adopted National AI Strategy, text and adoption instrument	The gazetted or Cabinet-approved strategy document, or a Ministry of ICT publication recording its adoption date	not yet probed
Artificial intelligence governance institution	A founding instrument or ministerial statement naming the body, its mandate and its budget line	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Copyright society directive on AI-generated works	The body's own statement, circular or board minute stating the rule, its effective date and its test for wholly AI-generated	not yet probed
Military artificial intelligence doctrine, oversight or procurement record	A defence ministry policy, a parliamentary defence-committee record, or a procurement register entry for the defence-force training pipeline	not yet probed
ICT sector share of GDP and sector employment	A statistical office national-accounts release or a regulator sector report giving ICT value added and employment, dated	not yet probed
Official ICT services export series after 2023	A central bank balance-of-payments services table or statistical office trade-in-services release for 2024 or later	not yet probed
Count of licensed technology firms and data centre operators	A regulator licence register or Registrar General extract listing ICT operators, dated	not yet probed
Startup Act or innovation legislation	A bill, act or Cabinet paper establishing a startup registration or incentive regime; nothing of the kind is held for Malawi	not yet probed
National innovation or venture fund	A fund instrument or budget line naming a state-backed innovation or venture facility, with capitalisation and dates	not yet probed
Technology hubs and incubators operating in Malawi	A directory or survey naming the hubs, their operators and their status; the base holds only one university innovation lab and one university facility	not yet probed
Startup funding raised, deals or jobs created	A deal-tracker dataset or an association report giving dated, per-year totals for Malawian startups	not yet probed
Malawi national budget documents	The 2025/26 and 2026/27 Approved Estimates of Expenditure on Recurrent and Capital Budget, or the Budget Statement itself; there is no domestic budget archive for Malawi, so every appropriation figure held is a journalist's or minister's reading	not yet probed
Universal Service Fund accounts	A regulator annual report or fund financial statement giving levy income, balance and project disbursement; the only statement held is the Director General's remark that funding is insufficient	not yet probed
Domestic state financing of digital transformation	A Ministry of Information and Digitalization vote in the Approved Estimates; the hub's financing block records the domestic-state series as pending, so all tracked deals are external	not yet probed
The Malawi-vendor signed instrument	A signed memorandum or framework agreement; only the ministry's account of a June 2026 meeting is held, with funding structure and timeline expressly not made public	not yet probed
National digital literacy measure or programme	A statistical office or regulator household ICT-access survey reporting digital skills, or a costed national digital literacy strategy; the wiki holds zero Malawi sources on this subject	not yet probed
National research capacity in digital technologies	A named research centre's funding line or publication record beyond the two university facilities held; no national digital research programme appears in the base	not yet probed
Acceleration project training and skills results	A project implementation status and results report against the results framework; the base holds only the appraisal targets and no reported achievement	not yet probed
Retail data and device affordability	A regulator-published tariff schedule or an affordability series; the base holds the appraisal's statement that 2GB costs almost 10% of annual gross national income per head, and nothing dated since	not yet probed
Rural-urban and gender divide in internet use	A disaggregated national ICT household survey; the base carries a mobile-money gender gap of 9.7 percentage points for 2025 and rural agent activity rates, but no internet-use split of any kind	not yet probed
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	The memorandum of understanding and the related data-sharing agreement themselves, a signature date, or a Malawian government statement naming the instrument. The text is withheld rather than unpublished, and is in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia	not yet probed

The absences cluster rather than scatter. Nothing at all is held on energy supply to telecommunications sites or data centres, on national technical capacity, or on digital literacy — three subjects with no Malawian source in the base at any date. Energy appears only as a constraint named by other people, as a barrier to school connectivity ([landscape analysis](#)).

The structural gap behind most of the others is that the communications regulator publishes nothing the wiki holds: no sector statistics, no subscriber series, no coverage figures, no fee schedule, no universal service fund accounts.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.